

YearCompass

2024 « / » 2025

Welcome

This is a web-based version of YearCompass. YearCompass is a PDF reflection booklet that has been published annually since 2012. The core team is Békéssy László, P. Tóth András, Vigh István.

I'm Michelle, a YearCompass fan since 2019 and creator of this unaffiliated web version. I fill out YearCompass during every holiday break to help me close one chapter and plan the next. I hope that this web version will bring these thoughtfully-designed questions to more people in new formats. While I'm not affiliated with their team, I've stayed true to their original questions and added optional AI analysis to help identify patterns in your responses.

I plan to keep updating and improving this through early January. Have a feature request or want to chat goal setting in general? Reach out at michellelu400@gmail.com, x.com/michlu2, or [book directly on my calendar](#).

Are my responses private?

Yes. I don't have any visibility into your responses, so this is your space to reflect. Responses are cached locally on your computer, in case you want to navigate away and come back.

Clear cached responses

Remove all saved responses from your browser

Clear
responses

What do I need to fill out the booklet?

A laptop (phone is OK but not recommended), a few hours of uninterrupted focus, and an open and honest mind.

If you don't have a few hours, you can also fill this out in parts -- your responses will be cached on your browser for you, and you can come back anytime.

Get ready

Arrive.

Prepare your tools and the space around you.

Close your eyes and take five deep breaths.

Let go of your expectations.

Start when you feel ready.

The Past Year

Going through your calendar

Go through last year's calendar week by week. If you see an important event, family gathering, friendly get-together or a significant project, write it down here.

- I took Ally skiing for her first time at Copper mountain
- Flew to Dallas for the health insurance sales pursuit (we didn't win it); got driven around by my coworker in his enormous pickup and listened to an entire Creed album
- Around this time I created a dunkin donuts inspired valentines day card
- Saw the Colorado Avalanche play the Dallas Stars for the first time
- Got my wisdom / molar teeth removed, which sucked for a while afterwards (ally took care of me though)
- Started calling my married or soon to be married friends while walking around the neighborhood. I was catching up but also trying to figure out if I was truly in love with ally
- Saw Mike Birbiglia live with ally
- Flew home to see my dad's retirement; wrote and spoke (and cried) in front of an audience. I also met dad's girlfriend, Pat, for the first time
- Flew to Boston before flying to Florida with Ally for Josh's wedding. At this wedding Ally was very mopey and I got upset at her for that
- Started going to see Molly, my RODBt therapist
- Broke up with Ally, my long term girlfriend
- Took Carter out on our first date to Kumoya on May 9th
- Flew to Vegas for Jakes bachelor party - this was the founding of the Bris Bois (new friend group). Coming back after this was exceptionally tough - Ally had moved out while I was gone and I came home from a bachelor party weekend on sunday to an empty house.
- Went to CJ's backyard bbq; met his sister and her friends (from SF) and heard about their brothers sexual deviance and the owner of the estate she was responsible for selling
- A lot of highlands farmers market trips
- Saw Bleachers at Red Rocks live with Liam - this was my first time at Red Rocks. The tickets were incredible and it was a lot of fun, but also I felt very bad about doing this without or instead of Ally. Also, tried to invite Carter but she declined
- Went to Boulder for a sushi send off for Ellen
- Went to SF for MDW. Stayed with Nelson and Chloe and hung out with them and Iain and Stod. This was when Iain broke the news about Yaz cheating on him. We bopped around the city, hiked,

boated, ate well, played tennis (this is around the time I resolved to learn tennis)

- Kicker's first baby, Nolan, was born!
- Met and befriended Katy and Nicole at tennis lessons
- Started doing hot yoga at yogabox
- Did a couple of run clubs, specifically O'dell's at Sloans Lake
- Started doing some informational interviews with some of Nelson's friends (Rami)
- Took tennis lessons with Mike Richmond
- Looked for a new apartment, signed for Highlands32, found Tejon, backed out of Highlands and moved into Tejon
- Visited Jeremy in LA for the 4th (but also told Carter I was in MV with Jake)
- Went to a few lenny's newsletter meetups with Edward
- My company started going through repeated rounds of layoffs; I somehow survived (so far)
- Went to Fort Collins to go for a hike and swim around horsetooth with Carter
- Went to Dillon to see Vampire Weekend live with Carter
- Joined a volo volleyball league solo
- Flew to SF for Jake/Ezera's birthday raft and to see star wars burlesque
- Got invisalign
- Went to Vinalhaven with my family for about 10 days
- Drove with Liam and Ellen to New Mexico for Jakes wedding at Ghost Ranch in Abiqui
- Went out with Liam and Jacob a few times
- Met Carin, career coach, who I ghosted
- Flew to Portland Maine for Will and Sasha's wedding with my rowing friends -- Iain fucked someone in the hotel hallway. And I reconnected with Abi - Also I forget if I told you about the vows from Will? Like I said they were beautiful, poignant, and hilarious but at one point he said maintain and pronounced it like meeyainteeain, like a Jamaican like slappa de beeasss. And Abi and I fucking lost it we were pinching each other to try not to double over in laughter
- Fell in love with Carter
- Started seeing Dr. Shah, a psychiatrist, and got back on an SSRI (zoloft)
- Celebrated Carter's birthday

- Ran my first half marathon (DOULDERHON)
- Bought my first tux
- Joined Gates tennis center for a bit
- Chatted with Alaina from BMC
- Oh traveled to Boston for a presentation to BMC about AI
- Flew to London with Carter, went to Gymkhana, the Churchill

This is what my past year was about

We live our lives through distinct but interconnected aspects. Take a look at the areas below and ask yourself what the significant events in each of them were. Write down your answers.

Personal life, family

I think this aspect (my personal life) underwent the most significant changes. Most significantly, I ended my five year relationship with Ally after much reflection and discussion with friends and family. I also started going to RDBT therapy and threw myself into new experiences like pottery, tennis, and a half marathon. I started dating

Career, studies

My company started falling apart this year - throughout it all, I was mostly on the bench and not really working. Many of my closest friends at Stellar Elements were let go or left and I really started to feel the loneliness of working remote (especially with not a lot of work to do). I started, slowly, the process of finding a new job - something I haven't done in about 7 or 8 years. On the flip side, I was

Friends, community

I reconnected heavily with more friends across my three major groups: my hometown, my crew friends, and my Colby friends. I drifted from the volleyball crew here at Denver, but started being more friendly with Carter's friends.

Relaxation, hobbies, creativity

Inspired by Carter and needing to distract myself, I started a few new hobbies, primarily pottery and tennis. I also started to rebuild an app that I love that no longer exists. Oh I also started taking film photography

Physical health, fitness

I maintained great health and fitness - rarely got sick, ran a half marathon, picked up tennis, maintained really great physique and pretty good energy levels. I reaffirmed the connection between my mental health and physical health.

Mental health, self-knowledge

I devoted time and energy to RDBT therapy and some light forms of journaling (especially with chatgpt). I also started taking SSRIs again. I went through some periods of intense loneliness and light depression, but came out the other side happy and healthy with the help of family, friends, and professionals. I also felt some intense

Habits that define you

Habits that define me include: exercise, cooking, catching up with friends, reading, pottery, and photography.

A better tomorrow

I'm going to continue leaning into fulfilling hobbies and activities like pottery, tennis, skiing, and running. I'm going to try to improve my cooking skills, learn to sing, and learn to play an instrument (piano and/or saxophone). I will also explore woodworking, likely hand carving. I'm going to be healthier and more secure in my relationship with Carter while continuing to challenge each other, grow together.

Six sentences about my past year

The wisest decision I made...

Ending things with Ally before they went too far.

The biggest lesson I learned...

I have friends and family that love me, even if I don't talk to them frequently. But also, many of my friends that are out in different cities with friends close by still go through similar periods of loneliness and longing.

The biggest thing I completed...

This is a tough one - a toss up between my half marathon, my RODBT skills class, and getting more settled into Denver on my own.

The most important thing I did for others...

Ending things with Ally, taking care of Carter (when she was sick, when she was down, etc.), being honest with Carter, helping my dad with Barnaby and Emma.

The biggest surprise of the year...

How quickly I fell in love with Carter. Though I guess this isn't too big of a surprise in retrospect.

The biggest risk I took...

Breaking up with Ally and staying in Denver.

Six questions about my past year

What are you most grateful for?

I'm most grateful for my friends, my dad, and Carter. I'm also grateful for my ability to be independently happy.

What is the best thing you have discovered about yourself?

That I can still have fun on my own, meet new people on my own, and learn new skills.

What were you not able to accomplish?

I really would have liked to have a new job.

Who are the three people you influenced the most?

Carter, Darci, Ally.

Who are the three people who influenced you the most?

Carter, Nelson, Molly (my therapist).

What are you most proud of?

I'm most proud of working on and for myself: standing up for myself, making tough decisions, being more open and honest with myself and others.

The best moments

Describe the greatest and most memorable, joyful moments from last year. How did you feel? Who was there with you? What were you doing? What kind of smells, sounds or tastes do you remember?

- Running the half marathon: I felt exhausted, heard cheers from bystanders, heard other runners and got to celebrate, exhausted, with Carter
- Seeing Vampire Weekend live in Dillon with Carter - enjoying the beer, being goofy, singing along, the hotel afterwards
- Seeing the Celtics live with Carter and Amy and Phil
- Seeing Alex get married; enjoying the wedding and after party with Carter
- London with Carter - the food at gymkhana, the singing out at the pubs, the football game (even though we were pretty deliriously exhausted throughout)

Three of my biggest accomplishments

Accomplishment 1:

Completing my first race, a half marathon

Accomplishment 2:

Dating Carter

Accomplishment 3:

Beating Mike, my coach, at Tennis

What did you do to achieve these?

I had an intention and target, I put in time and effort, and I embraced being a beginner and learning.

Who helped you achieve these successes? How?

Mike helped me by coaching and and being patient with me. Carter helped me by challenging and inspiring me.

Three of my biggest challenges

Challenge 1:

Being single (breaking up with Ally caused a lot of financial distress and loneliness).

Challenge 2:

My job and job search (lack of consistently challenging and gratifying work made my work pretty unenjoyable; i'm still facing a lot of inertia in the job search).

Challenge 3:

Dating again - being vulnerable, trusting.

Who or what helped you overcome these challenges?

My family, my friends, Carter, my coworkers and network.

What have you learned about yourself by overcoming these challenges?

I am more resilient than I thought and able to handle multiple huge changes at once, but am better with the support of friends and family.

Forgiveness

Did anything happen during the past year that still needs to be forgiven? Deeds or words that made you feel bad? Or are you

angry with yourself? Write it down here. Do yourself good by forgiving.*

** If you don't feel ready to forgive yet, jot it down anyway. It can work wonders.*

I need to forgive myself for breaking up with Ally and for getting jealous about Carter. It's ok that I did these things and felt this way, it's understandable because of my past and most people in my situation have validated that they'd do and feel similarly. My friends, family, and Carter all love me.

Letting go

Is there anything else you need to say? Is there anything you have to let go of before you can start your next year? Write it down and let it all go.

My sister can't help the way she behaves at home and it's not a reflection of me or my dad. Carter loves me and it's ok that her behavior makes me uncomfortable sometimes, that's more of a reflection of me and some of the things I need to let go of. One thing I realized upon further reflection is another pattern in my dating history - after the break up with Alice, I think I may have internalized some anxiety relating to Alice acting a little aloof and independent. Additionally, I think that the fact that she hooked up with someone who she had explicitly said she didn't like might have made it hard for me to fully believe my girlfriend when they say something like "I like him as a friend." I wonder if this might have led me to enjoy the

The past year in three words

Choose three words to define your past year.

Change

Independence

Love

The book of my past year

A book or a movie was made about your past year. What title would you give it?

The Year of Leaving and Landing

Goodbye to your last year

If there is anything else left that you would like to write down, or there is anybody you would like to say goodbye to, do it now.

I'd like to say goodbye to Ally - it's likely we won't connect again, but our relationship did mean a lot to me even though it wasn't right and I hold a lot of memories and identity tied up in that. It's also wrapped up in lingering effects from the social isolation. I want to let go of insecurity.

You're done with the past year.

Take a deep breath.

If you'd like, take a break and come back tomorrow, or spend some time analyzing with AI (click the brain icon on the right) before moving on.

When you're ready, let's plan 2025.

The Year Ahead

Dare to dream big

What does the year ahead of you look like? Why will it be great? What would happen in an ideal world? Let go of your expectations and dare to dream.

Next will be great because I will:

- double my salary working on an interesting problem with a team I really enjoy
- be in the best shape of my life, as proven by a number of different physical feats (like doing a split and running a marathon)
- stay close with old friends
- make new friends
- be the most confident I've ever been
- hone existing skills (cooking, pottery, tennis, skiing, painting)
- add new skills (woodworking, do a split, swing dance, sing

This is what my next year will be about

Take a look at the areas of your life and decide your goals for each of them for the next year. Put those goals on the page—this is the first step towards realizing them.

Personal life, family

- Deepen my relationship w/ Carter by: (doing things that we'll remember our entire life, practicing vulnerability and direct communication, laying down traditions or rituals)
- Reconnect with old friends by: continuing to chat with friends from high school and college, plan trips
- Strengthen my relationship with Emma by working together on what we want out of it, what that requires, and how we get there
- Spend more time with my dad
- Reach out to my cousins, visit them, and strengthen connections
- Use journaling to practice gratitude and reflect on and process my values and emotions
- Prioritize increasing the surface area of my life through things like

Career, studies

- Define a new career trajectory and make a move to drive that forward, from defining (and automating?) a clear application plan to thriving in a new role
- Expand my professional network by expanding my network in general - Schedule at least one informational interview or coffee chat per month with industry leaders or peers, Attend local or virtual events in product management, AI, or UX to connect with like-minded professionals, make genuine connections with more people across the broader surface area created by putting myself out there

Friends, community

- Visit friends individually, invite them out
- Schedule at least one trip each with high school, rowing, and college friends
- Join clubs relating to my hobbies, skills and interests
- Host more - every time I meet someone new throw a party or event (potlucks, game nights, hikes, etc.)
- Take some photos for Wooden Spoon, Steam, and other local businesses I like

Relaxation, hobbies, creativity

- Create a calming evening ritual without becoming dogmatic about it (possibly: journaling and reading)
- Take more advantage of YogaBox's hot yoga pass
- Check social media less (possibly produce more though)
- Create a weekly/monthly/quarterly plan to develop my various

Physical health, fitness

- run a marathon
- PR in a half marathon
- achieve a full split
- win a tennis tournament
- ski a blue glade without falling or stopping long
- go on a multi day backpacking trip
- trail run whenever possible
- get at least an 85 on Eight Sleep every night
- maintain a consistent skincare routine
- use additional therapies to prevent and reverse hair loss
- 40" vertical jump or at least enough to be able to dunk on a regulation hoop

Mental health, self-knowledge

- maintain a light, consistent journaling habit including a gratitude practice and celebrating small wins
- be less reactive to emotions, disentangle my identity from my emotions
- practice self-enquiry at least once a week

Habits that define you

- journaling
- exercise
- a wind down routine
- reading
- creative outlets
- pushing out of my comfort zone through things like public speaking and improv
- make progress towards my goals every day

A better tomorrow

- Happiest year
- Healthiest (physical and mental) year
- Most creative year - meaning actual practice that involves creating things
- A challenging year that pushes me out of my comfort zone
- Most fulfilling and lucrative for my career
- 820 on my credit score

Magical triplets for the year ahead

I will love these three things about myself.

My willingness to push outside of my comfort zone

My ability to learn and grow

The care I put in for myself and

I am ready to let go of these three things.

Jealousy / insecurity

Overemphasizing what others think

Inertia

I want to achieve these three things the most.

A new fulfilling job

Exorcising the jealousy or insecurity

Make money from a hobby (whether that's wood, pottery, etc.)

These three people will be my pillars during rough times.

Emma & Dad

Carter

Conor & Alex

I will dare to discover these three things.

My candidate-

What it feels like to
fully trust myself

My goals, purpose,
and values

I will have the power to say no to these three things.

Too much work

Hurtful or
inappropriate

Social events if my
health/social

I will make my surroundings cozy with these three things.

Great smells

Great music (jazz?)

Meaningful art and

I will do these three things every morning.

Exercise

Write down 3

Get morning

I will pamper myself with these three things regularly.

Coffee from a cafe

Screen-free

Yoga

I will visit these three places.

The Alps

Portugal

France

I will connect with my loved ones in these three ways.

Time with Emma
not at home, and

Reaching out to
and visiting my

Calling my dad
frequently

I will reward my successes with these three presents.

A car (and maybe a
motorcycle)

Recognizing and
savoring my
accomplishments

Plenty of travel

Six sentences about my next year

This year will be special for me because...

I am prioritizing my growth, exploration, independence, vulnerability, and connection.

This year I advise myself to...

Prioritize consistency and effort over perfection and outcomes, take small steps every day, reflect on and appreciate my accomplishments and what I've overcome

This year I will say yes when...

Opportunities arise that align with my values, challenge me to grow, or bring joy and connection into my life. Things like chances to meet new people, strengthening existing relationships, there's a chance to try something new.

This year, I will be bravest when...

I lean into vulnerability, share my feelings openly, and pursue paths that feel uncertain but have the potential to lead to extraordinary outcomes.

This year I will draw the most energy from...

Meaningful connections, engaging work, creative pursuits, trying new things, and the sense of accomplishment that comes from disciplined effort (vs. outcomes).

This year I will not procrastinate any more over...

Starting new creative projects, learning new skills, or taking decisive action towards finding a job that truly excites and fulfills me.

My word for the year ahead

Pick a word to symbolise and define the year ahead. You can look at this word if you need some extra energy, so you remember not to give up your dreams.

Momentum

Secret wish

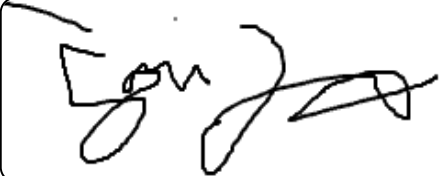
Unleash your mind. What is your secret wish for the next year?

I wish to rediscover the playfulness and spontaneity that adulthood sometimes hides, to approach life with curiosity instead of control, and to find magic in the small moments. I want to look back on this year and feel, not just that I moved forward, but that I was truly present for the journey.

I want to move my life forward in ways that Simon Sarris describes in

I believe anything is possible this year.

Signature:



Clear

Date:

01/05/2025

You've made it to the end! Congratulations on planning your year. If you'd like, here are a few additional actions you can take:

Analyze your responses with AI (click the brain icon!)

[Print or download your responses as PDF](#)

(first [collapse all overflowing text boxes](#) and/or [reduce text size](#))

[Email your responses to yourself](#)

[Copy responses to clipboard to paste elsewhere](#)

[Email michellelu400@gmail.com with requests and feedback](#)